

KOKOROE

JumpStart Microgrant Prototype Budget

Requested funding tier: \$2,500

This budget supports an expanded browser-based MVP for Kokoroe, a manga- and comic-inspired social messaging platform. Expenses are tied directly to prototype development, testing, and early product validation. No funds will be used for founder compensation, travel, or meals.

SOFTWARE AND LICENSING FEES		\$700
• Cloud deployment and managed database services for the beta MVP		\$280
• Limited AI API credits for context classification and opt-in masking tests		\$250
• Browser, accessibility, and device-testing tools		\$100
• Design, asset-processing, and development-platform licenses		\$70
TECHNICAL SERVICES		\$1,500
• Independent security and privacy review of authentication and messaging		\$300
• Accessibility and responsive-interface review		\$175
• Facilitated usability review before broader beta testing		\$175
• Contracted room-theme illustration refinement for testable chat worlds		\$300
• Contracted avatar identity-asset refinement		\$250
• Contracted bubble-shell and comic-style interface-asset refinement		\$300
MARKET ANALYSIS AND VALIDATION		\$300
• Survey and structured beta-feedback tooling after customer discovery		\$120
• Approved beta-test recruitment or participant incentives		\$180
TOTAL REQUEST		\$2,500

EXPECTED MVP OUTCOME

A browser-testable multi-user messaging prototype with polished illustrated worlds, expressive message presentations, improved reliability and usability, and early validation of narrowly scoped AI-assisted expression features.

BUDGET NOTE

Market-validation expenses will be used after customer discovery or I-Corps participation. Any participant incentives will be used only with Innovation Hub guidance and applicable Texas Tech approval.